ACTIVITY 3

Design a Clause-to-Process Audit Checklist

ISO 9001 Quality Management System (QMS) Internal Auditor Training
TGS-2023039341 · K1 · K2 · A1 · A2 · LO1 · LO2 · 60 minutes

Objective

Create a working document that supports process-based auditing without turning the audit into a compliance questionnaire.

Scenario

MPS buys critical heat-treated components from approved suppliers. A new supplier was approved quickly after a delivery disruption. Incoming inspection found variable hardness, yet purchasing records show no change to supplier risk status or monitoring frequency.

Materials

- Supplier-control process summary and evidence list
- ISO 9001 requirement-intent map (paraphrased)
- Blank checklist and sample-plan workbook

Activity questions

- Which process risks and requirements should the checklist prioritise?
- Which questions test effectiveness rather than the mere existence of a procedure?
- What sample size and selection logic are proportionate to the available time and risk?
- How will the auditor record both conformity and nonconformity evidence?

Required evidence

- Completed audit checklist
- Sampling rationale
- Usability review
- Revised final checklist

Detailed Procedure

1. Review the supplier-control process and identify the intended output: externally provided products that conform to requirements.

2. Select the relevant requirement themes: approval criteria, selection, monitoring, re-evaluation, communicated requirements and risk-based controls.

3. Convert each requirement theme into an open audit question linked to the actual process sequence.

4. Add a risk-focused follow-up question for each high-risk point. Ask how effectiveness is known, not only whether a document exists.

5. Define expected evidence for each question using records, interviews and observation where appropriate.

6. Create a sampling plan that covers the new supplier, one established critical supplier and one recent quality event.

7. Add fields for actual evidence, finding status, requirement reference and follow-up needed.

8. Walk through the checklist in process order and remove duplicated or leading questions.

9. Exchange checklists and conduct a usability test: another learner should be able to use it without explanation.

Acceptance Check

The checklist follows the process, covers the relevant requirement intent, uses open questions, includes a risk-based sample and provides space for objective evidence.

Learner completion checklist

Done	Evidence / output	Reviewer comment
■	Completed audit checklist	
■	Sampling rationale	
■	Usability review	
■	Revised final checklist	